

INTERMEDIATE VA – 2

Directions for questions 1 and 2: Four alternative summaries are given below each text.

Choose the option that best captures the essence of the text and indicate the number corresponding with it in the box provided below each question.

While emotional decisions can be dangerous, dataless decisions can be fatal. By nature, most entrepreneurs are risk-takers. We have a little bit of gambler in us, so it is easy to take gut decisions even when the odds are against us. Instead of dice on pure instinct, consult the figures on the spreadsheets or your group of trusted advisors. Make decisions based on solid facts, not just the excitement of the moment.

- ^{1.} Spur of the moment decisions are bound to be dangerous, so be discreet in making decisions based on facts.
- ^{2.} Business decisions should be based on concrete figures and sound counsel rather than on emotions.
- ^{3.} Everyone takes risks, but only those who take decisions based on solid data can succeed in business.
- ^{4.} Business decisions taken without sufficient data will have momentous consequences.

Solution:

The following are the key points of the argument above:

(1) For entrepreneurs, emotional decisions are dangerous, but decisions not based on data can be very grave.

(2) They should base their decisions on concrete facts and guidance from trusted friends.

These two points are expressed in brief in option 2. While the first point is covered in option 1, it distorts the second point. Option 3 misses the point of making decisions based on emotions. Option 4 misses the first point, and slightly distorts the second point.

Ans : (2)

Directions for questions 1 and 2: Four alternative summaries are given below each text.

Choose the option that best captures the essence of the text and indicate the number corresponding with it in the box provided below each question.

It is said that there are two types of Internet users — those who have been hacked, and those who will be hacked. That is why, more alarming than the recent suspected security breach of over 6.5 million debit cards issued by at least 19 different banks is the fact that the Indian financial system is still not wise enough to create adequate security and damage-control systems to cope with such a possibility. Multiple agencies are investigating, but the dimensions of the damage are not yet fully apparent.

1. India is vulnerable to debit card data theft.
2. Some internet users have not been hacked so far, but they are likely to be hacked in future.
3. Since the Indian financial system is not sufficiently secured, security breach of debit cards happens at times.
4. In spite of the security and damage-control systems in force, India is unable to protect some of its debit cards from being hacked.

Solution:

The key points of the paragraph are:

- (1) A few million debit cards issued by banks have been hacked.
- (2) Our financial system has not created adequate security and damage-control systems to meet possible hacking in future.

Both these points are concisely summarized in option 1. Option 2 elaborates on the illustration and misses the main point. 'At times' in option 3 tones down the gravity of the situation. Option 4 distorts the second point by using 'some'.

Ans : (1)

Directions for questions 3 to 5: The sentences given in each question, when properly sequenced, form a coherent paragraph. Each sentence is indicated with a number. Choose the most logical order of sentences to construct a coherent paragraph and indicate the correct sequence of numbers in the box provided below each question.

- ^{1.} The Indian community that has settled in Britain has helped deepen ties.
- ^{2.} It stands to reason that for her first foreign visit outside Europe after taking over as Prime Minister, Theresa May chose India.
- ^{3.} They are two pillars of the Commonwealth, sharing democratic values and a world view on many political issues including terrorism.
- ^{4.} India and the UK have many reasons to have close relations.
- ^{5.} Today, India is the third largest investor in the U.K., and the U.K is the largest G20 investor in India.

Solution:

Statement 4 begins the paragraph by stating that India and the U.K have many reasons to have close relations. Statements 3, 1 and 5, in that order, follow 4 by giving reasons to support that India and the UK share close relations. Statement 2 concludes the paragraph by stating that because India and the UK share close ties, it is quite obvious that Theresa May chose India for her first foreign visit outside Europe after taking over as Prime Minister. Hence 4,3,1,5,2 is the logical sequence.

Ans : (43152)

Directions for questions 3 to 5: The sentences given in each question, when properly sequenced, form a coherent paragraph. Each sentence is indicated with a number. Choose the most logical order of sentences to construct a coherent paragraph and indicate the correct sequence of numbers in the box provided below each question.

1. Nothing can be more elementary and universal than the fact that choices of all kinds in every area are always made within particular limits.
2. This budget constraint is omnipresent and is faced by every consumer.
3. When we decide what to buy at the market, we can hardly ignore the fact that there are limits on how much we can spend.
4. The existence of choice does not, however, indicate that there are no constraints restricting choice.
5. Choices are always made within the limits of what are seen as feasible.
6. The freedom to determine our loyalties and priorities is a particularly important form of liberty which we have reason to recognize, value, and defend.

Solution:

Sentence 6, which equates the idea of the 'freedom of choice' to a form of liberty and which is a general statement, can be the opening sentence. 4 follows 6 as it concedes the fact that freedom, however does not mean there are no constraints. Sentence 1 emphasizes what 4 says by saying limits exist in every area. 5 brings out one such limit, feasibility (in general) and 3, another limit, expenditure (specific). 2 concludes the para.

Ans : (641532)

Directions for questions 3 to 5: The sentences given in each question, when properly sequenced, form a coherent paragraph. Each sentence is indicated with a number. Choose the most logical order of sentences to construct a coherent paragraph and indicate the correct sequence of numbers in the box provided below each question.

- ^{1.} The BBC used images of bodies extremely sparingly, it concentrated on wide shots, avoided graphic close ups and when filming cremations started half way through to show only the flames, not the bloated corpses piled up at the beginning.
- ^{2.} The Indian public should get an opportunity to discuss what gets piped into their homes or dropped through their letter boxes.
- ^{3.} It was in contrast to parts of the Indian media whose own readers complained their pictures did not show any respect to the dead and treated humans as no better than 'dead fish'.
- ^{4.} Events like the tsunami demanded from broadcasters and publishers mature editorial judgements about what really needs to be shown and what doesn't.

Solution:

1 does not appear to be the first sentence of the paragraph. It seems more appropriate to follow something else. Between 2 and 4, 2 is the central point 4 is more like an illustration. Hence 2 can begin the paragraph and 4 follows it. 1 and 3, in that order, follow 4. Hence 2413 is the correct sequence.

Ans : (2413)

Directions for question 6: The following question presents 5 statements of which 4, when placed in appropriate order would form a contextually complete paragraph. Pick the statement that is not part of that context.

1. In 2009, India and Japan began an annual strategic dialogue.
2. There are several riders to this rosy prognosis, however.
3. When India conducted its nuclear tests in 1998, Japan was the country that took it the hardest: it put all political exchanges with India on hold, froze aid and announced economic sanctions within hours.
4. This has now come to fruition with the signing of the nuclear cooperation agreement in Tokyo during the Prime Minister's visit.
5. A thaw in ties didn't come until 2001, when sanctions were lifted.

Solution:

Statement 3 begins the paragraph by talking about the stance taken by Japan when India conducted its nuclear tests in 1998. Statement 5, which states that a thaw in the hostilities did not take place until 2001, is a logical continuation of 3. Statement 1 follows 3 by mentioning that India and Japan began a strategic dialogue in 2009. "This" in 4 refers to the "strategic dialogue" in 1. Hence statements 3, 5, 1 and 4 form a paragraph. Statement 2 can begin a different paragraph but cannot form a part of the sequence mentioned above.

Ans : (2)

Directions for questions 7 and 8: Each of the following questions presents 4 statements of which 3, when placed in appropriate order would form a contextually complete paragraph. Pick the statement that is not part of that context.

1. It aims to replicate all the functions of a smartphone in a device perched on a person's nose.
2. Some 10,000 people are already testing a prototype of Google Glass, a miniature computer worn like spectacles.
3. But as cameras shrink and the cost of storing data plummets, it is individuals who are taking the pictures.
4. Its flexible frame holds both a camera and a tiny screen, and makes it easy for users to take photos.

Solution:

The entire passage talks about a product by Google called Glass, which acts as a camera, can be placed between the eyes, above the nose and used. The odd sentence hence is (3). The reason being, sentence (1) talks about the functions of glass, sentence (2) talks about the population who is using it and sentence (4) talks about the accessibility of Glass. The common feature in (3) and (4) is that both talk about taking pictures. (3) talks about cameras in general and (4) talks about Glass. Hence, (3) can be eliminated. The sequence would then be 2, 1 and 4.
Ans : (3)

Directions for questions 7 and 8: Each of the following questions presents 4 statements of which 3, when placed in appropriate order would form a contextually complete paragraph. Pick the statement that is not part of that context.

1. As a solution to rampant inflation, in Venezuela banning price rises and jailing shopkeepers, has limited potential.
2. Basic goods such as milk, rice, cooking oil and toilet paper are rarely found on supermarket shelves.
3. But President Nicolas Maduro is undaunted.
4. For good measure he had a couple of dozen shopowners and managers arrested for 'usury'.

Solution:

The passage talks about inflation in Venezuela. The entire passage lists down various points of inflation. But point (2) is the odd sentence. Points (1), (3) and (4) are directly connected because point (1) gives the problem, point (2) mentions how the President is unnerved by it and (4) shows his meagre reaction towards inflation. Point (2) does not fit in. Point (2) brings out a result of inflation not a solution and hence, it can be eliminated, making the sequence 1, 3 and 4.
Ans : (2)

Directions for question 9: The following question has a paragraph from which the last sentence has been deleted. From the given options, choose the one that completes the paragraph in the most appropriate way.

According to popular opinion, we are now living in a "filter bubble" on social media that shelters us from views outside of our own. We connect with people with similar views, and block, delete, or ignore those who are different, whilst social media's own algorithms make sure we repeatedly see only what we want to see. Whether or not this bubble in some way caused the election of Donald Trump is up for debate.

1. What is clear, however, is that it made many of us blind to the world around us.
2. We first became aware of the bubble after Brexit, but now it is clearer than ever before.
3. Social media allows unprecedented access to millions of viewpoints, yet we are not taking advantage of this.
4. For many on the left, the election win of Donald Trump came as a supreme shock.

Solution:

The sentence which precedes the blank states that whether the filter bubble caused the election of Donald Trump is not clear, so the sentence which sums up the argument should be one that presents a contrast. Hence, statement A, which begins with however and states that the bubble made us blind to the world around us, is ideally the concluding statement.

Ans: (1)

Directions for questions 10 to 12: Each question has a sentence with two blanks, followed by four pairs of words as choices. From the choices, select the pair of words that can complete the given sentence best.

If the government can bring together the _____ strands of its economic diplomacy and give it bureaucratic _____ and political purpose, India would dramatically enhance its standing in the region and beyond in the coming years.

☐ a) dismissive . . . continuity

☐ b) disparate . . . coherence (Correct Answer - ✓)

☒ c) disparaging . . . linkage (Your answer - ✗)

☐ d) disproportionate . . . reference

Solution:

Choice (B) is the appropriate answer. If the government can bring together the disparate (containing elements very different from one another) strandsbureaucratic coherence (logical and consistent) and political purpose,

The remaining pairs of words are not suitable in the context.

dismissive: something unworthy of consideration
continuity: uninterruptedness,
disparaging: insulting
linkage: a system of links
disproportionate: excessive
reference: The action of referring to some thing.

Choice (B)

Directions for questions 10 to 12: Each question has a sentence with two blanks, followed by four pairs of words as choices. From the choices, select the pair of words that can complete the given sentence best.

Gandhi's repeated triumphs against human _____, stunned his awestruck countrymen and made him an object of reverence, even to those who were otherwise very _____ of his fasts and religious appeals.

☒ a) barbarism . . . appreciative (Your answer - ✖)

☐ b) frivolity . . . dismissive

☐ c) savagery . . . critical (Correct Answer - ✔)

☐ d) benignity . . . deprecatory

Direction for questions 13 and 14: In each of the following questions, the word at the top is used in four different ways, A to D. Choose the option in which the usage of the word is INCORRECT or INAPPROPRIATE.

Fall

☒ a) Her face fell when she thought about her father who passed away in an accident. (Your answer - ✖)

☐ b) She was in such a dire situation that she had no choice but to fall over her knees and pray.

☐ c) There has been a sharp fall in night temperature since last week.

☐ d) The principal thought that the only way to make him fall in line was to punish him.

Solution:

The correction here is – fell to her knees or fell on her knees. Choice (B)

Direction for questions 13 and 14: In each of the following questions, the word at the top is used in four different ways, A to D. Choose the option in which the usage of the word is INCORRECT or INAPPROPRIATE.

Fly

☐ a) He flew into a rage when he came to know that his son had failed the final exams.

☒ b) A strong urge to fly into the face of convention prompted him to take up arts for his graduation when all his siblings were doctors. (Your answer - ✓)

☐ c) He is so adept at playing the keyboard that his fingers flew across the instrument.

☐ d) Rumours were flying around the city just a few days before they got married.

Directions for question 15: In the following question, there are five sentences. Each sentence has pairs of words / phrases that are italicized and highlighted. From the italicized and highlighted words / phrases select the most appropriate words /phrases to form correct sentences. Then from the options given choose the best one.

The fact that the *pygmy* [a] / *dwarf* [b] is actually a member of the royal family is a heavily guarded secret.

Not all kinds of mushrooms are *eatable* [a] / *edible* [b].

The *duel* [a] / *dual* [b] between the two adversaries took a new turn when one of them fainted.

He likes to lie *prone* [a] / *supine* [b] on the cool green poolside grass and look at the stars in the sky.

With a lot of effort the crippled man finally managed to *prise* [a] / *pry* [b] the lid from the jar.

☐ a) babab

☐ b) aaabb

☐ c) baaab

☐ d) bbaba (Correct Answer - ✓)